

Qin Li

Postdoctoral Fellow

Department of Communication, University of Missouri

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Mis- and disinformation, Computational Social Science

Academic Appointments

2024 – now **Postdoctoral Fellow**, Department of Communication, University of Missouri
Preparing Future Faculty for Inclusive and Excellence Postdoctoral Program

Education

2019 – 2024 **Ph.D.**, Communication, The Ohio State University
Dissertation: “In people we trust: The effect of trust and network closure on factual beliefs and misinformation sharing” (**Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award**)
Advisors: Dr. R. Kelly Garrett, Dr. Robert M. Bond

2017 – 2019 **M.A.**, Communication, Washington State University

2013 – 2017 **B.A.** Journalism (with honors), Fudan University
Specialization: Information Science and Technology

Peer-reviewed Journals

denotes shared first-authorship where two authors contribute equally to a publication.

* denotes graduate student co-author at the time of submission.

6. #**Li, Q.**, #Bond, R. M., Dixon, G. N., Hovick, S. R., Na, K., Nisbet, C. E., Wegener, D. T., & Garrett, R. K. (Forthcoming). The limited effect of social media use on political and health misperceptions: Evidence from digital trace data and panel surveys. *PLOS ONE*. [[Multidisciplinary Sciences](#); 5Y IF = 3.2]
5. Warner, B., **Li, Q.**, *Gillespie, B., *de Braganca Peixoto, J., Winfrey, & K. Madrigal, G. (2026). Race and gender politics in the podcast sphere and their consequences. *Journal of Radio and Media Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19376529.2026.2613209> [[Comm Journal](#); 5Y IF = 1.0].
4. **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K. (2023). Misperceptions in Sociopolitical Context: Belief Sensitivity’s Relationship with Battleground State Status and Partisan Segregation. *Journal of Communication*. 73(5), 439-451, <https://doi.org/10.1093/joc/jqad017> [[Flagship Comm Journal](#); 5Y IF = 5.5]

3. **Li, Q.**, Hassel, H. J., & Bond, R. M. (2023). Journalists' networks: Homophily and peering over the shoulder of other journalists. *Plos One*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0291544> [Multidisciplinary Sciences; 5Y IF = 3.2]
2. Li, Y., Wang, Z., & **Li, Q.** (2023). Presidential communication during the pandemic: a longitudinal examination of its relationship with partisan perceptions and behaviors in the United States. *Human Communication Research*. 49(4), 433–447. <https://doi.org/10.1093/hcr/hqad025> [Flagship Comm Journal; 5Y IF = 3.3]
1. Nisbet, E. C., Mortenson, C., & **Li, Q.** (2021). The presumed influence of election misinformation on others reduces our own satisfaction with democracy. *Harvard Kennedy School (HKS) Misinformation Review*. <https://doi.org/10.37016/mr-2020-59> [Interdisciplinary, Specialized Journal]

Book Chapters and Other Articles

3. **Li, Q.** (2026). Is it just about the facts? The case for a critical, pro-democracy approach to information integrity. *Journal of Applied Communication Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00909882.2025.2573951> [Comm Journal; 5Y IF = 2.6]
2. **Li, Q.** (2026). Not all falsehoods are equal: A critical examination of mis- and disinformation during the 2024 U.S. presidential Election. In B. R. Warner, D. G. Bystrom, M. S. McKinney, & M. C. Banwart (Eds.), *Democracy on the line: The turbulent 2024 presidential election*.
1. Winfrey, K. L., *de Braganca Peixoto, J., **Li, Q.**, Madrigal, G., Warner, B. (2026). From Playboys to Cat Ladies: Masculinity and Gender in the 2024 Presidential Election. In B. R. Warner, D. G. Bystrom, M. S. McKinney, & M. C. Banwart (Eds.), *Democracy on the line: The turbulent 2024 presidential election*.

Work Under Review

5. **Li, Q.**, Warner, B., & Madrigal, G. (R&R). Critical disinformation discourse about immigrants on social media during an election: Evidence from X/Twitter and survey data. *International Journal of Communication*. [Comm Journal; 5Y IF = 2.2]
4. Bond, R. M., **Li, Q.**, Nisbet, E. C., & Garrett, R. K. (R&R). Rallying the Base, Corroding the Truth: Elite Communication, Misperceptions, and the Communication of Democratic Decline. *Political Communication*. [Flagship Comm Journal; 5Y IF = 7.3]
3. **Li, Q.**, *Wippell, J., *Hunt, J., Yadon, N., Bond, R. M., & Tien, J. (Under review). How online social networks foster expression of alternative identities and narratives about race: A cross-platform analysis of right-Leaning online communities using BERT model and Structural Topic Modeling. *Political Psychology*. [Flagship Poli Sci Journal; 5Y IF = 5.3]
2. #**Li, Q.**, #Garrett, R. K., Bond, R. M., & Nisbet, C. E. (Under review). Social media use and partisan divergence in misinformation detection in the 2024 US election.
1. Flanagan, W., Mortenson, C., **Li, Q.**, *Xu, S., *Barnowski, H., & Nisbet, C.E. (Under review).

DemocracyBench: A Vignette-Based Dataset and Stochastic Sampling Method for Auditing Democratic Values in LLMs. *NeurIPS*.

Selected Work in Progress

2. **Li, Q.** (In prep). How dyadic trust impacts factual beliefs and (mis)information sharing: Evidence from an online interactive human-agent experiment.
1. **Li, Q.** (In prep). Toward a behavioral measure and manipulation of dyadic trust in computer-mediated communication: An extension of economic trust games using bots.

Awards and grants

2026	Postdoc Teaching Award, University of Missouri
2025	Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award, Political Communication Division, National Communication Association (NCA)
2025	MU Postdoctoral Association Travel Award, University of Missouri
2024	GitHub Student Developer Program Award, GitHub
2024	School of Communication Peer Award, The Ohio State University
2019-2024	School of Communication Research Grant (\$8,000), The Ohio State University
2019	Graduate School Fellowship (\$26,316), The Ohio State University
2018	Graduate and Professional Student Association Travel Grant, Washington State University
2018	Murrow College Brelsford Scholarship, Washington State University
2018	Murrow College Travel Grant, Washington State University
2018	Student Travel Award, International Communication Association

Selected Grant Experience

2025	“A New Measurement Science for the Evaluation of AI Systems” Funder: University of Missouri Big Ideas Grant (\$75,000; Funded) PI/co-PIs: Behm-Morawitz, E. (Communication), & Davis-Stober, C. (Psychology) Role: Collaborator
2025	“Evaluating AI Systems’ Ability to Measure Value-laden Concepts” Funder: OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$1,000; Submitted) Role: Principal Investigator
2025	“Toward a Theoretical and Empirical Understanding of Epistemic Risks of and Epistemic Trust in AI in Communication Science.” (\$240,000; Unfunded)

- Funder: The Sloan Foundation
 Role: Principal Investigator
- 2024 “Structured network science approach to monitoring online discourse about race.”
 PI/co-PIs: Tien, J., Bond, R. M., & Yadon, N.
 Role: Research assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)
 Funder: Translational Data Analytics Institute, The Ohio State University
- 2020 - 2023 “RAPID: Quantifying the Downstream Effects of COVID-19 Online Health Information on Risk Perceptions, Decision Making, Policy Preferences, and Preventive Health Behaviors.”
 PI/co-PIs: Nisbet, E. C., Bond, R. M., Dixon, G., Garret, R. K., Hovick, S., Na, K., & Wegener, D. T.
 Funder: National Science Foundation
 Role: Research assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)
- 2020 - 2023 “Quantifying Harms of Misinformation during the U.S. Presidential Election.”
 PI/co-PIs: Nisbet, E. C., Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K.
 Funder: Facebook
 Role: Research Assistant (*Data management, cleaning, and analysis*)

Conference Presentations

15. **Li, Q.**, Warner, B., & Madrigal, G. (Accepted). “Identity-based discourse on social media during an election: Evidence from X/Twitter and survey data.” *National Communication Association, Political Communication Division*.
14. Warner, B., **Li, Q.**, Gillespie, B., de Braganca Peixoto, J., Winfrey, & K. Madrigal, G. (Accepted). “Race and gender politics in the podcast sphere and their consequences.” *National Communication Association, Political Communication Division*.
13. **#Li, Q.**, *Wippell, J., *Hunt, J., Yadon, N., Bond, R. M., & Tien, J. (2026). How online social networks foster expression of alternative identities and narratives about race: A cross-platform analysis of right-Leaning online communities using BERT model and Structural Topic Modeling, *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting, Political Communication Preconference*, Boston, MA.
12. *Gaw, F., **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., Garrett, R. K., & Nisbet, E. (2026). “Social Media, Metaperceptions, and Political Violence in the 2024 Election,” *American Political Science Association 2026 Annual Meeting*, Boston, MA.
11. **Li, Q.**, Dai, Y., & Koncilja, K. (2026). “Measuring Anti-democratic (Dis)information Flows Using Human-centered Artificial Intelligence (AI) Method,” *Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms*, Davis, CA.

10. **Li, Q.** (2025). "Candidates as a source of mis- and disinformation during the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election," to be presented at *National Communication Association 110th Annual Convention*, Denver, CO.
9. **Li, Q.** (2025). "In People We Trust: How Dyadic Trust Impacts Factual Beliefs and (Mis)information Sharing," presented at *International Communication Associations 75th Annual Conference, Division of Political Communication*, Denver, CO.
8. **Li, Q.** (2023). "In people we trust: the effect of political homophily and network closure on factual beliefs," submitted to *National Communication Association 109th Annual Convention, Division of Political Communication*, National Harbor, MD.
7. Bond, R. M., **Li, Q.**, Nisbet, E. C., & Garrett, R. K. (2022). "The effect of campaign rallies on misperceptions," presented at *The 5th Annual Conference of Politics and Computational Social Science*, Boston, MA.
6. **Li, Q.**, Bond, R. M., & Garrett, R. K. (2022). "Misperceptions in the sociopolitical context: Effects of battleground state status and partisan segregation," presented at *International Communication Associations 72th Annual Conference, Division of Political Communication*.
5. Li, Y., Wang, Z., & **Li, Q.** (2021). "White House Communication and Its Impact on the Public during the Pandemic," presented at *International Communication Associations 71th Annual Conference*.
4. **Li, Q.** (2018). "Political Conservatism and Media Effect of Strategic Framing: Evidence from China," presented at *2018 American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting*, Political Communication Pre-Conference, Boston, MA.
3. Daud, I., **Li, Q.**, Wang, M., Borah, P. & Himelboim, I. (2018). "Campaign strategies on Twitter in 2016 U.S. presidential election: Real-time event, negativity, and online engagement," presented at *2018 Annual Conference of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)*, Division of Political Communication, Washington, DC.
2. Wang, M., Borah, P., **Li, Q.**, & Himelboim, I. (2018). "Twitter strategies used during the 2016 U.S. presidential election: Donald Trump and Mike Pence vs. Hillary Clinton and Tim Kaine," presented at *2018 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Division of Communication Technology, Plague, Czech Republic.
1. Liu, X., **Li, Q.**, & Chang, C-W. (2017). "Discussion with weak ties and perceived political agreement among Chinese youth: A mediation approach," presented at *2017 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Digital Asia Pre-Conference, San Diego, CA.

Invited Talk

Research

Qin Li, Presenter. 2026. Misinformation in Political Networks. Department of Psychology, University of Missouri.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2026. How Social Media Contribute to Misperceptions and Identity-based Participation, University of South Florida.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2025. Online Critical Disinformation Networks. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. The Limited Effect of Social Media Use on Political and Health Misperceptions: Evidence from Panel Surveys and Behavioral Data. Center for Social Media and Politics, New York University.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. Within and Beyond Social Media: The Information Environment and Factual Beliefs. College of Information & Department of Political Science, University of Maryland, College Park.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. Within and Beyond Social Media: The Information Environment and Factual Beliefs. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2023. Within and Beyond Social Media: The Information Environment and Factual Beliefs. Department of Communication, Department of Communication, Ohio State University.

Qin Li, Presenter. 2020. Introduction to Web Scraping Using Python and R. Computational Research Methods Group, School of Journalism and Mass Communication, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

Professional Development

Qin Li, Panelist. 2025. Proseminar Panel on Campus Interviews. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Qin Li, Panelist. 2025. Proseminar Panel on Zoom Interviews. Department of Communication, University of Missouri.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching

Political Communication (PhD-level), University of Missouri	Fall 2025
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.85-5.0/5.0)	

Undergraduate Teaching

Intro to Communication Technology (online, asynchronous), Ohio State University	Summer 2024
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.7/5.0)	
Industry Research Methods (in-person), Ohio State University	Fall 2022, Fall 2023
Instructor of record (Average SEI: 4.6-4.7/5.0)	
Multimedia Content Creation (in-person), Washington State University	Fall 2018, Spring 2019
Lab Instructor	
Media and Society, Washington State University	Fall 2016, Spring 2017
Teaching Assistant	
Communication and Global Contexts, Washington State University	Fall 2016, Spring 2017
Teaching Assistant	

Guest Lecture

Introduction to Communication Theory (PhD-level), University of Missouri

Fall 2025

Lecture on Theory Construction in Political Misinformation Research

Specialized Teaching Training

July 2024 CIRTL @ Ohio State Associate Endorsement, Michael V. Drake Institute for Teaching and Learning, The Ohio State University

September 2023 Inclusive Teaching Endorsement, Michael V. Drake Institute for Teaching and Learning, The Ohio State University

Service

Mentorship in the Department

2025 – now Mentor of Undergraduate Students (Lucy Berger, Andrew Mueller, Natalie Schaefer), Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2021, 2023 Peer Mentor, School of Communication, The Ohio State University

Department Service

2024 – now Research Committee, Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2024 – now Faculty Co-organizer, Political Communication Institute (PCI), Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2024 – now Faculty Member, International Teaching Assistant Support Group, Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2022 – 2024 Treasurer, School of Communication Graduate Student Association, The Ohio State University

2023 Organizer, Graduate Student Summer Writing Group, School of Communication, The Ohio State University

2021 – 2022 Graduate Representative, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee, School of Communication, The Ohio State University

2018 – 2019 Secretary, Graduate Student Association, Murrow College of Communication, Washington State University

Mentorship in the Field

Jun 2025 Mentor of Graduate Student, Division of Political Communication, International Communication Association

Ad-hoc Journal Review

Human Communication Research (2025) - 1

Political Behavior (2024) - 1

International Journal of Communication (2024) - 1

Mass Communication and Society (2024) - 1

Conference Review

International Communication Association Annual Conference

Political Communication Division (2021, 2024, 2025); Computational Methods Division (2024, 2025); Communication Technology Division (2024)

National Communication Association Annual Conference

Political Communication Division (2026);

Professional Affiliations

International Communication Association

National Communication Association

American Political Science Association

Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication

Research groups

2024 – now Political Communication Institute (PCI), Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2024 – now Media & Diversity Center (MDC), Department of Communication, University of Missouri

2023 – now Violence, Ideology, and Extremism Working Group (VIEW), Mershon Center, The Ohio State University

2022 – 2024 Computational and Statistical Models (COSMOS) Group, Department of Communication, The Ohio State University

Specialized Academic Training

Aug 2018 Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan
Courses: Causal Inference, Categorical Data Analysis

Industrial Experience

Aug–Dec Data journalist intern, China Business Network, Shanghai Media & Entertainment Group
2016 (Shanghai’s major television network), Shanghai, China
Summer Journalist intern, Jiefang Daily (Shanghai local newspaper), Shanghai United Media Group,
2015 Shanghai, China

Skills

Advanced: R, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, OTree, NetLogo
Intermediate: Python, Heroku, SAS, Stata

References

Dr. R. Kelly Garrett
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School of Communication
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Dr. Robert M. Bond
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Dr. Erik C. Nisbet
Owen L. Coon Endowed Professor of Policy Analysis and Communication
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